

Emily Lucinda Kurtz

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Current Position

Visiting Assistant Professor of Statistics, Department of Mathematics & Statistics, Carleton College.

Education

Ph.D. Political Science, University of Minnesota, 2025.

Major Fields: American Politics & Political Methodology
Minor Field: Population Studies; Population Studies Trainee at Minnesota Population Center
Committee: Jane L. Sumner, Paul Goren, Andrew Karch, Josef Woldense
Dissertation: Specters of Sectors: How Place-Linked Identity Influences the Politics of Economic Transition

M.A. Political Science, University of Minnesota, 2023.

M.S. Statistics, University of Minnesota, 2022.

Thesis: "The partyvoter Package: Simulating and Visualizing Ideological and Partisan Voting"

B.A. Mathematics and Environmental Studies, Wellesley College, 2015.

Publications

Straw, C. M., Principe, F. M., **Kurtz, E. L.**, Wiese-Bjornstal, D. M., & Horgan, B. P. (2020). Within-field variability of turfgrass surface properties and athlete performance: Modeling their relationship using GPS and GIS technologies. *Proceedings of the Institution of Mechanical Engineers, Part P: Journal of Sports Engineering and Technology*, 234(2), 170-175.

Godbole, A., Kelley, E., **Kurtz, E.**, Prałat, P., & Zhang, Y. (2017). The total acquisition number of the randomly weighted path. *Discussiones Mathematicae Graph Theory*, 37(4), 919-934.

Papers Under Review

"Could You Let Me Check Your Work?" Assessing the Accessibility of Replication Materials. Co-authored with McWay, R. (at Political Analysis)

The Statistical Significance of Statistical Insignificance. A Reproduction Study of 'The Null Result Penalty.' Co-authored with McWay, R. (at Journal of Applied Econometrics)

Race, Ethnicity, and Moral Values: On the Measure and Mismeasure of Moral Values in the American Public. Co-authored with Goren, P. & Barrett, C. (at Political Behavior)

Not If But When: How Survey Launch Time Impacts Sample Labor Market Characteristics. Co-authored with Sumner, J. L. (at Political Analysis)

Measuring County-Level Deindustrialization in the United States. (at Political Science Research and Methods.)

Selected Working Papers

It's Time for More Time Series Clustering in Political Science. (Reject and resubmit at Political Analysis)

Not in My Labor Market?: Environmental Regulation, Psychological Proximity, and Fear of Job Losses.

Sunlight and Silicon: The Politics of Green and Digital Infrastructure in an Era of US - China Rivalry.

The partyvoter Package: Simulating and Visualizing Ideological and Partisan Voting.

Works in Progress

The Racial Geography of Protectionist Sentiment. With Sumner, J. L.

Man Hands on Misery to Man: Family History, Opposition to Globalization, and Enduring Legacies of Deindustrialization. With Sumner, J. L.

Grants, Honors, and Awards

Towsley Endowment for Student Research Partnership, Summer 2026

Claggett Fellowship, Summer 2021 & Summer 2024

University of Minnesota Graduate Research Partnership Program Fellowship, Summer 2021, Summer 2022, & Summer 2024

Ueland Fellowship, Summer 2021, Summer 2022, Summer 2023, Summer 2024, & Summer 2025

Minnesota Population Center Graduate Student Research Development Grant, Fall 2023

Ornstein Fellowship in American Politics, Summer 2023

Data Science for the Public Good Graduate Fellowship, Summer 2021

Bernard W. Lindgren Award for Excellence in Statistics Teaching, Spring 2018

Lynn Lin Fellowship for Statistical Consulting, Spring 2018

University of Minnesota Statistics PhD First Year Scholarship, Fall 2017

Conference Presentations

"Sunlight and Silicon: The Politics of Green and Digital Infrastructure in an Era of US - China Rivalry," presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, 2026.

"Measuring County-Level Deindustrialization in the United States," presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, 2026.

"The Racial Geography of Protectionist Sentiment," presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, 2025.

"A New Way to Quantify County-Level Deindustrialization in the United States," presented at the American Political Science Association Annual Conference, Philadelphia, 2024.

“Measuring County-Level Deindustrialization in the United States,” presented at the Annual Conference of the Society for Political Methodology, Riverside, 2024.

“When do We Give Companies a Pass to Destroy the Environment?,” presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, 2024.

“Cortisol and Obama-Trump Voting: The Link between Chronic Stress and ‘Risky’ Candidates,” presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference, Chicago, 2023.

“Gray Code Distance 2 Graphs” presented at the Joint Mathematics Meetings, San Antonio, 2015.

Tools and Packages

partyvoter. 2022. <https://marekjozsef.shinyapps.io/partyvoter/>

Allows users to visualize spatial voting in multiple dimensions, in multiparty systems, and with varying party loyalty and political information among voters.

Teaching

Instructor of Record (Carleton College)

STAT 270: Statistical Learning, Winter 2027

STAT 220: Introduction to Data Science, Spring 2026

STAT 120: Introduction to Statistics, Fall 2025, Winter 2026, Spring 2026

Instructor of Record (UMN)

POL 3085: Quantitative Analysis in Political Science, Summer 2023

Lab Instructor (UMN)

POL 3085: Quantitative Analysis in Political Science, Spring 2024 & Spring 2025

STAT 3032: Regression and Correlated Data, Spring 2020

STAT 5032: Applied Regression Analysis, Fall 2019

STAT 4101/5101: Theory of Statistics I, Summer 2019

STAT 3701: Introduction to Statistical Computing, Fall 2018

STAT 3021: Introduction to Probability and Statistics, Spring 2018

STAT 3011: Introduction to Statistical Analysis, Fall 2017

Teaching Assistant (UMN)

POL 3321: Issues in American Public Policy, Spring 2022

POL 1001: American Democracy in a Changing World, Fall 2021

Teaching Assistant (Wellesley College)

QR 260: Applied Data Analysis and Statistical Inference, Summer 2015

MATH 116: Calculus II, Fall 2013

Research with Undergraduates

Carleton College Department of Mathematics & Statistics

Student Research Partner Faculty Supervisor, Summer 2026

Worked with four undergraduate students on a project focused on collecting information on American cultural institutions (museums, monuments, statues, etc.) Created a collection of comprehensive, clean, and publicly accessible datasets of these institutions, their nature, their locations, etc. Published end product on the web so that other researchers can use the dataset, understand it better through blog posts demonstrating its use, and explore it through interactive apps, visuals, tables, plots, etc.

University of Virginia Biocomplexity Institute

Data Science for the Public Good Graduate Student Fellow, Summer 2021-Spring 2022

Led diverse teams of undergraduate students on two data science projects with benefits to the public. Studied occupations in the Skilled Technical Workforce and their benefits to economic mobility in the United States. Also studied the role data repositories play in data sharing and their benefits to the scientific community and society as a whole.

Other Research Experiences

Minnesota Population Center (as Graduate Research Assistant):

Short Term Research Assistant, Summer 2022-Spring 2023.

Performed data analysis tasks for various PIs on projects related to population studies. Work for each project lasted 4 weeks, and tasks included collection, cleaning, automation of processes, statistical analysis, and data set creation for the IPUMS data base.

Institute for Research in Statistics and its Applications (as Graduate Research Assistant):

Graduate Research Consultant, Summer 2018-Spring 2019.

Aided student and faculty researchers on campus and in private organizations with the statistical components of their work. Employed classical statistics and machine learning techniques in R and Stata. Worked with teams in fields ranging from languages to earth sciences and medicine.

Service

Carleton College Department of Mathematics and Statistics

Stats and Data Science Contests Co-organizer, 2025-present

University of Minnesota Department of Political Science

Co-organizer, UMN Minnesota Political Methods Colloquium, 2023-2024

Graduate Student Life Committee Member, 2023-2024

Organizer, UMN American Politics Colloquium, 2021-2024

Graduate Student Mentor, 2022-2023

University of Minnesota

Justice, Council of Graduate Students (COGS), 2023-2025

Director of Internal Relations, COGS, 2022-2023

Representative to the Board of Regents, COGS, 2021-2022

Graduate Student Senator, University Senate, 2020-2022

Software and Programming Skills

R, L^AT_EX, GitHub, Qualtrics, Shiny, Microsoft Office, ArcGIS Online, Stata

Professional Affiliations

American Political Science Association

Midwest Political Science Association

Society for Political Methodology

References

Dr. Jane L. Sumner Professor, University of South Carolina Political Science

jlsunmer@sc.edu

Dr. Paul Goren Professor, University of Minnesota Political Science

612-624-7513, pgoren@umn.edu

Dr. Andrew Karch Professor, University of Minnesota Political Science

612-624-1393, ajkarch@umn.edu

Dr. Katie St. Clair Professor, Carleton College Mathematics and Statistics

507-222-4193, kstclair@carleton.edu

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